Please check the examination details below before entering your candidate information

Candidate surname	Other names

Centre Number

Candidate Number

Pearson Edexcel GCSE (9-1)

Thursday 4 June 2026

Morning (Time: 1 hour 50 minutes - total time for **both** booklets)

History

BOOKLET B4: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Paper reference

1HI0/B4 (Paper 2)

You must have:
The corresponding booklet P.

Total Marks

Instructions

- Use **black** ink or ball-point pen.
- **Fill in the boxes** at the top of this page with your name, centre number and candidate number.
- There are two booklets in this question paper. **This is booklet B.**
- Answer questions 1(a), 1(b), 2 and **either 3 or 4** in this booklet.
- Check you have the corresponding booklet P.
- Answer the questions in the spaces provided *- there may be more space than you need.*

Information

- The total mark for this booklet is 32.

- The total time for **both** booklets is 1 hour 50 minutes.
- The marks for **each** question are shown in brackets
  - use this as a guide as to how much time to spend on each question.
- **Do not forget to complete booklet P.**

Advice

- Read each question carefully before you start to answer it.
- Try to divide your time equally between each booklet of the question paper.
- Check your answers if you have time at the end.

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Turn over ▶

Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Answer Question 1(a), Question 1(b), Question 2 and EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

1 (a) Describe one characteristic of poverty in early Elizabethan England. (2)

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(b) Describe one characteristic of the English attempts to colonise Virginia. (2)

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(Total for Question 1 = 4 marks)

2 **Explain why the Northern Earls' Rebellion (1569-70) posed a significant danger to Elizabeth I.** (12)

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- Mary, Queen of Scots
- Anglo-Spanish relations

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

Turn over ▶

(Total for Question 2 = 12 marks)

Turn over ▶

Answer EITHER Question 3 OR Question 4.

EITHER

3 **"Economic difficulties were the most significant challenge Elizabeth faced upon her accession in 1558."**

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- The royal debt
- Elizabeth's claim to the throne

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 3 = 16 marks)

OR

4 **"Spanish strategic errors were the primary cause of England's triumph over the Armada."**

How far do you agree? Explain your answer.

*You **may** use the following in your answer:*

- The command of the Duke of Medina Sidonia
- The deployment of fireships

*You **must** also use information of your own.*

(Total for Question 4 = 16 marks)

Indicate which question you are answering by marking a cross in the box ☒. If you change your mind, put a line through the box ☒ and then indicate your new question with a cross ☒.

Chosen question number: Question 3 ☐ Question 4 ☐

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TOTAL FOR BOOKLET B = 32 MARKS

PLEASE ENSURE YOU ALSO COMPLETE BOOKLET P.

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